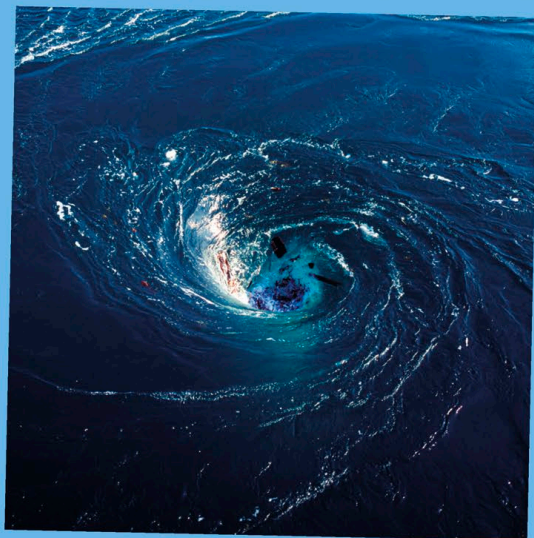




Whirlpools

At the point where different currents meet, a spiral of swirling water sometimes develops. This is called a whirlpool. Most are weak, but some are powerful and are known as maelstroms. Their strong spin can pull swimmers and boats underwater.



Volcanoes

Most active underwater volcanoes are found at the edge of tectonic plates. These hot spots cause the Earth's crust to split, which releases lava and volcanic ash. Water cools the lava and ash, creating hard rocks known as pillow lava.

Tsunamis

The sudden motion of an earthquake or volcano can lead to giant waves of water, known as tsunamis. Shock waves caused when part of the ocean floor moves can create a series of fast waves traveling toward the coastline.

